while trying to make it appear that it was a Soviet idea; he proposed a moratorium on nuclear weapons testing; and he called for the elimination of *all* nuclear weapons by both sides by the end of 1999—but *only* if the United States renounced "the development, testing and deployment of space-strike weapons," a reference to SDI.

It was propaganda, yes, but we couldn't ignore it.

"Gorbachev surprisingly is calling for an arms reduction plan which will rid the world of nuclear weapons by the year 2000," I wrote in my diary January 15. "Of course, he has a couple of zingers in there which we'll have to work around. But at the very least it is a h—1 of a propaganda move. We'd be hard put to explain how we could turn it down." I made this entry in my diary only a few days later: ". . . over to the Oval Office for staff and N.S.C. meetings and then five Afghan children were brought in. They were mere babies. But all victims of Soviet bombings. One little girl with her face virtually destroyed. Three with one arm each and one without one leg. I'd like to send the photos to Gen. Secretary Gorbachev."

Although I agreed with the goals of Gorbachev's proposal, there were enormous problems to be solved before we could work out an agreement that was equitable and verifiable and airtight in preserving our security. Great problems were posed in reaching an agreement not only by the differences between the Soviets' huge force of land-based missiles and our three-pronged force of land-, sea-, and air-launched missiles, but by the great size of the Warsaw Pact countries' conventional forces in Europe, which dwarfed those of NATO; by French and English nuclear missiles that the Soviets regarded as a threat to them but on which we were in no position to negotiate restrictions; and by Soviet intermediate-range missiles that were aimed at Europe from Asia.